NARRATIIVE

GROWTH BLUEPRINT / 2026

KatKin

The science cats deserve

From category claim to category authority



INTERNAL REVIEW DRAFT - HUMAN APPROVAL REQUIRED

Executive Thesis

Deploy the underutilised peer-reviewed research asset as the anchor for a distinctive brand platform, closing the self-diagnosed awareness gap behind the first CMO hire, ahead of rising paid-social CAC and competitor SEO/AI-search gains eroding the DTC funnel.



COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

KatKin's next growth question is about where existing strengths can compound.

SOURCES: S5, T1

APPROVED STRATEGY + VERIFIED FACT

The Commercial Question

This deck separates what outside-in evidence supports from what only company access can answer.



COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Where could KatKin's next meaningful growth come from?

SOURCES: S1A, S1B, S1C, S3, S5

INTERPRETATION + VERIFIED FACT

Market Reality

SAMENESS

Shared functional language

DISCOVERY

Organic and AI search shift

THE PRESSURE

UK fresh-frozen cat food functional vocabulary ('real meat, no fillers, vet-formulated') has commoditised across DTC entrants; Untamed matches near-identical claims with roughly a quarter.

ECONOMICS

Paid creative pressure

MANDATE

Build a loved brand

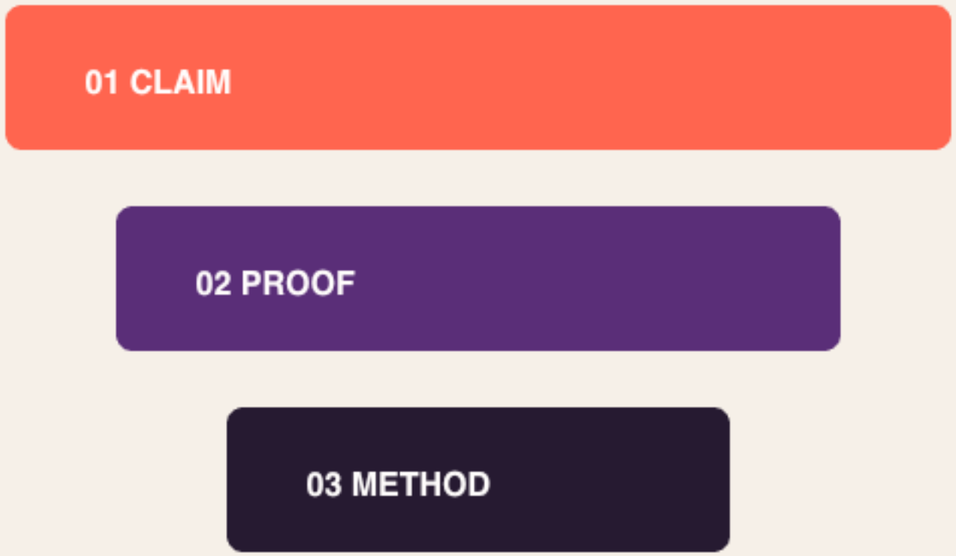
COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Category context creates pressure, but does not diagnose KatKin by itself.

SOURCES: S2, S3

INTERPRETATION + VERIFIED FACT

Category Growth Dynamics



No independent verification of KatKin's claimed 2% market share beyond trade press reporting.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Premiumisation and category polarisation make the middle harder to defend.

SOURCES: S2

VERIFIED FACT

Competitive Landscape

01

DISCOVERY

Competitors own different trust and value cues; KatKin's combination remains a hypothesis.

02

DECISION

KatKin's defensible proof points are its peer-reviewed, published AGE research (Journal of Animal Science), Board-Certified Veterinary Nutritionist.

03

REPEAT

Competitors own different trust and value cues; KatKin's combination remains a hypothesis.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Competitors own different trust and value cues; KatKin's combination remains a hypothesis.

SOURCES: S4, S6

MIXED FACT AND HYPOTHESIS + VERIFIED FACT

The Sea of Sameness



THE HARD PART IS ALREADY DONE

Brand platform and proof hierarchy should foreground the published research as the lead differentiator, since this is currently underused relative to testimonial-led creative.

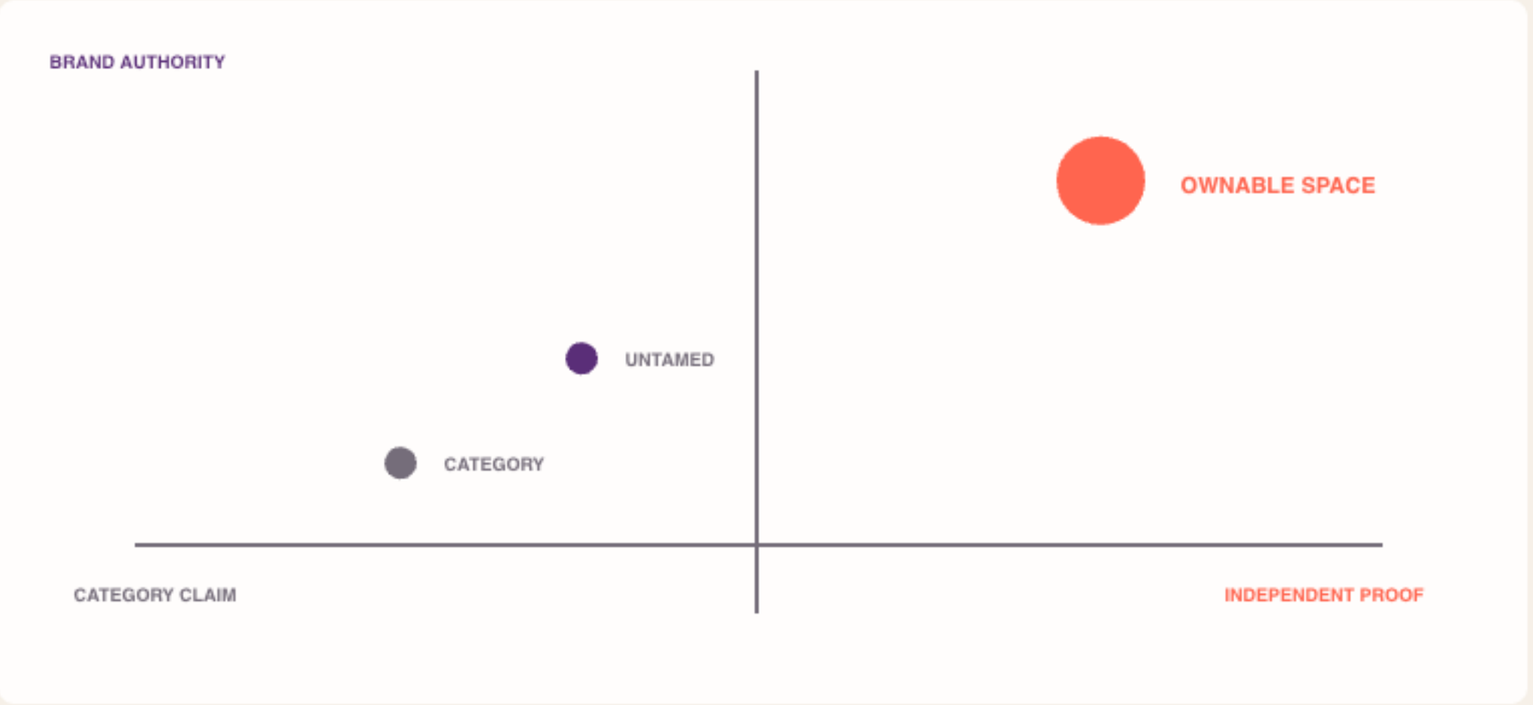
COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

KatKin needs a reason to be remembered, not another generic category claim.

SOURCES: S4

MIXED FACT AND HYPOTHESIS

The Market Gap



THE GAP

Independent science made easy to feel and easy to inspect

HYPOTHESIS TO VALIDATE

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

KatKin can test an under-leveraged space where independent proof builds brand authority.

SOURCES: S2, S3, T1

STRATEGIC INTERPRETATION

Growth Constraint Diagnosis

POSITION	Proof, not promise
BENEFIT	Confidence without self-audit
PLATFORM	The science cats deserve
EXPRESSION	Visible without personalisation

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Trust and conversion are constrained by unresolved proof and proposition questions.

SOURCES: S2, S3, T1

APPROVED STRATEGY + INTERPRETATION + VERIFIED FACT

The Provocation

WHAT OWNERS SEE

Confident claims

Fresh. Real meat. Vet formulated.

THE GAP

WHAT KATKIN CAN PROVE

Independent science

The category asks owners to trust confident nutrition claims; KatKin can instead make independent evidence the starting point.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

A public trust contradiction can undermine a trust-dependent growth story.

SOURCES: S2, S3, T1

STRATEGIC INTERPRETATION

Audience Reality

01

COMMITTED DTC

Outside-in evidence cannot yet support confident buyer segmentation.

02

RETAIL CONVERT

Approved priority audience is affluent retail converts and prospective mainstream owners, sequenced behind the committed DTC early-adopter base.

03

MAINSTREAM OWNER

Outside-in evidence cannot yet support confident buyer segmentation.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Outside-in evidence cannot yet support confident buyer segmentation.

SOURCES: S2, T1

APPROVED STRATEGY + VERIFIED FACT

Audience Segments / Demand Pools

01

COMMITTED DTC

Potential buyer jobs are a research question, not a settled segment model.

02

RETAIL CONVERT

No first-party client data was supplied in this evidence pack to validate behavioural segmentation design.

03

MAINSTREAM OWNER

Potential buyer jobs are a research question, not a settled segment model.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Potential buyer jobs are a research question, not a settled segment model.

SOURCES: S2, T1

APPROVED STRATEGY + VERIFIED FACT

NARRATIIVE

Customer Evidence Board

CUSTOMER SAYS

Public reviews surface value and transition friction.

SEARCH SHOWS

Competitors are gaining organic and AI-search visibility.

REVIEWS REVEAL

Strong aggregate satisfaction coexists with price pressure.

SOCIAL SHOWS

High creative volume converges on familiar functional claims.

The opportunity is directional: make proof easier to find without claiming first-party validation.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Public customer, search and social signals support a direction, not a settled segment truth.

SOURCES: S3, S4, S5

MIXED VERIFIED FACT + INTERPRETATION

Audience Tensions / Decision Context

01

DISCOVERY

The useful tension is between breadth of appeal and clarity of choice.

02

DECISION

Segmentation design must rely on existing login/order-cadence/proxy-income signals only, per activation principle, and must define a distinct.

03

REPEAT

The useful tension is between breadth of appeal and clarity of choice.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

The useful tension is between breadth of appeal and clarity of choice.

SOURCES: S5, S6, S7

VERIFIED FACT

Category Entry Points

01

HEALTH RESET

A health concern prompts active nutrition discovery.

02

PROOF SEEKER

An owner compares claims and looks for credible evidence.

03

RETAIL TRIAL

Shelf communication must convert without a personal quiz.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Different entry points may require different proof and proposition jobs.

SOURCES: S2, S4, S6, T1

PROPOSED TEST

Current Brand Diagnosis

POSITION	**Proof, not promise**
BENEFIT	**Confidence without self-audit**
PLATFORM	**The science cats deserve**
EXPRESSION	**Visible without personalisation**

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

KatKin's current proposition is observable; its effectiveness is not proven.

SOURCES: S1A, S1B

VERIFIED FACT

Positioning Problem

POSITION	Proof, not promise
BENEFIT	Confidence without self-audit
PLATFORM	The science cats deserve
EXPRESSION	Visible without personalisation

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

The positioning hypothesis depends on resolving a credibility contradiction first.

SOURCES: T1

APPROVED STRATEGY

Strategic Positioning

Move from the copyable claim that fresh food is better to a provisional position: cats deserve nutrition validated by independent science, not manufacturer assertion.



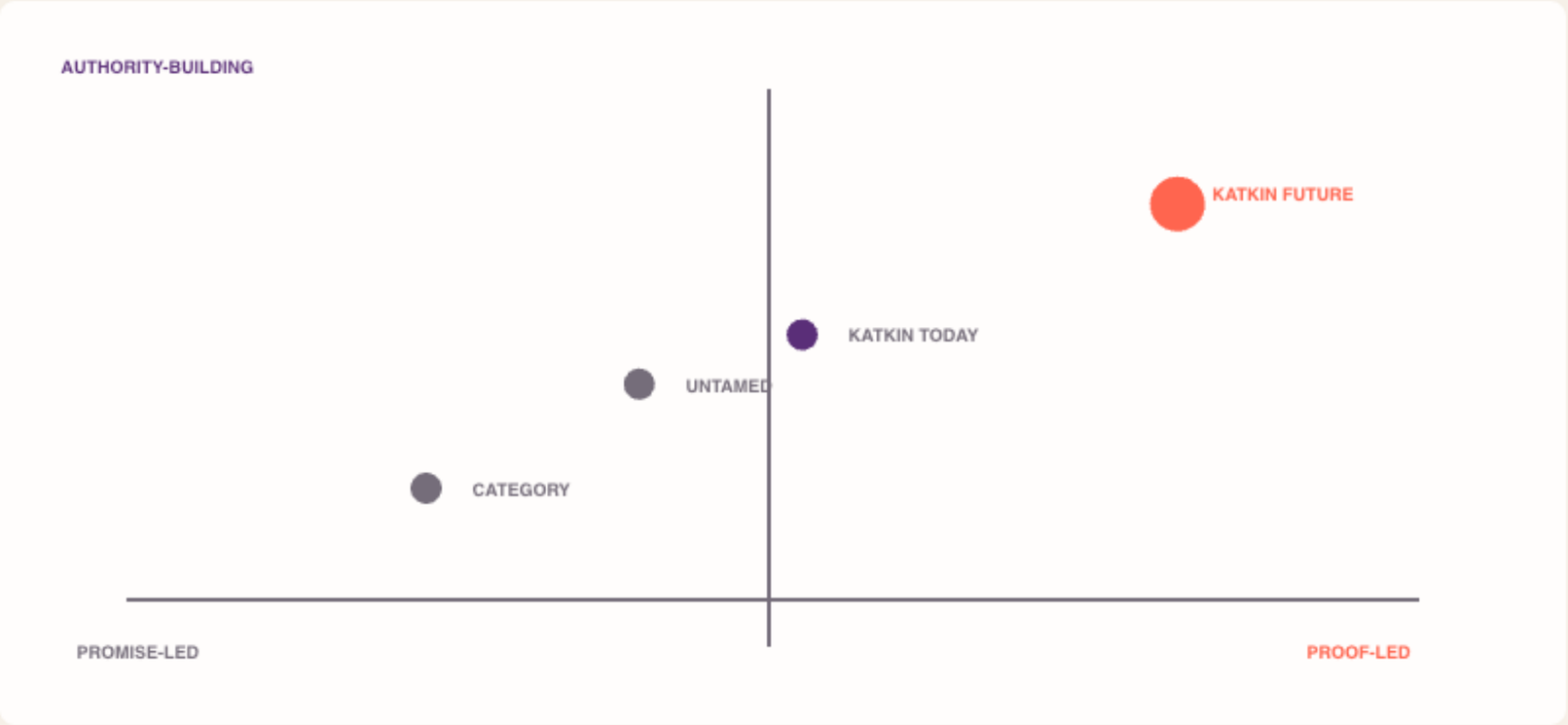
COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

The approved positioning is a testable strategic hypothesis, not a proven market fact.

SOURCES: S2, S3, T1

PROPOSED POSITIONING

Positioning Map



OWNABLE TERRITORY

Nutrition proven, not promised

Positions are hypotheses.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Move from familiar promise-led nutrition claims toward proof-led authority, subject to founder and customer validation.

SOURCES: S2, S3, T1

POSITIONING HYPOTHESIS

Narrative Platform

1

TENSION

The category asks owners to trust claims

2

SHIFT

KatKin makes proof the starting point

3

RESOLUTION

Independent science carries the decision

THE SCIENCE CATS DESERVE

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

A clearer progression could turn breadth of range into a guided reason to return.

SOURCES: S2, T1

APPROVED STRATEGY + VERIFIED FACT

Core Message Architecture

MASTER MESSAGE

Nutrition proven, not promised

Narrative translation work must produce a shelf-legible version of the science claim within the few seconds available at point of sale, distinct from the longer-form DTC/CRM articulation.

PUBLISHED

Peer-reviewed research

FORMULATED

Board-Certified Veterinary Nutritionist

MADE

Vertically integrated production

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

One front door can make two subscription jobs easier to understand.

SOURCES: S2, T1

APPROVED STRATEGY + VERIFIED FACT

Messaging Territories / Distinctive Assets

01 / PROOF, NOT PROMISE

ROLE	Credibility
TENSION	Distrust of category claims
PROOF	Peer-reviewed research
ASSET	Coral evidence mark

02 / THE SCIENCE CATS DESERVE

ROLE	Emotional meaning
TENSION	Nutrition complexity
PROOF	Veterinary formulation
ASSET	Clinical crop + warm line

03 / VISIBLE CONFIDENCE

ROLE	Retail translation
TENSION	Shelf-glance uncertainty
PROOF	Layered source path
ASSET	Observe / mark / signal

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Three territories let campaigns vary while one evidence behaviour compounds recognition.

SOURCES: S2, S4, T1

PROPOSED MESSAGING SYSTEM

Commercial Prize

Scenario	Target share	Revenue upside	Contribution	Margin assumption
Conservative	2.25%	£1.50m	£0.45m	30%
Base	2.50%	£3.00m	£1.20m	40%
Ambitious	3.00%	£6.00m	£3.00m	50%

ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIOS. MARKET SHARE AND CONTRIBUTION MARGIN ARE ASSUMPTIONS, NOT COMPANY FORECASTS.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

A 0.5-point share gain implies about £3.0m in incremental annual revenue in the base scenario.

SOURCES: S8, S1A

ESTIMATE + ASSUMPTION

Attention Strategy

NOTICE

One coral evidence signal

REMEMBER

Proof before promise

CONNECT

Science with intimate cat behaviour

VERIFY

A readable path to the source

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Earn memory by repeating one visible evidence signal across every decision context.

SOURCES: S2, S5, T1

PROPOSED ATTENTION STRATEGY

Channel Roles

DTC QUIZ	Discovery and education	Personalised
CRM	Trust and retention	First party
RETAIL	Conversion	Unaided
EARNED / SEARCH	Scale discovery	Citable
PAID SOCIAL	Volume	Rebalanced

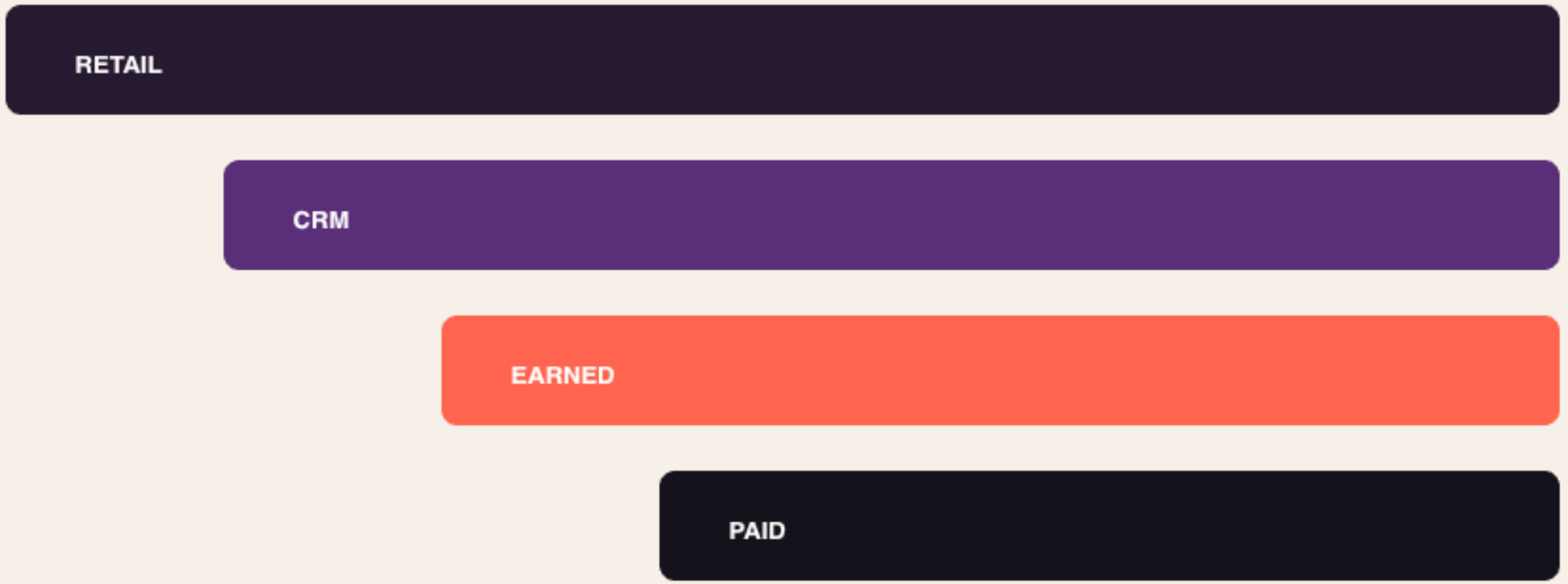
COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Channels remain hypotheses until channel economics and conversion evidence are available.

SOURCES: T1

APPROVED STRATEGY

Content / Campaign System



Execution should test the proposition architecture, not multiply generic content.

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Execution should test the proposition architecture, not multiply generic content.

SOURCES: T1

APPROVED STRATEGY

Creative Direction / Next-Phase Hook

CLINICAL PRECISION

meets

INTIMATE CAT BEHAVIOUR

01 OBSERVATION

Tight crops and watchful eyes

02 EVIDENCE

Visible marks that show what was checked

03 SIGNAL

One coral cue points to the proof

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

A distinctive world turns the published science into a recognisable visual behaviour, not another nutrition claim.

SOURCES: T1, S2

PROPOSED CREATIVE TERRITORY

Growth Priorities / 90-Day Activation Plan

DAYS 1-30

Foundation

Founder pressure-test and evidence audit

DAYS 31-60

Prove

Retail translation and CRM pilot

DAYS 61-90

Scale

Shift spend only when leading signals move

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Start with a capped, reversible test and a separate claims audit.

SOURCES: T1

APPROVED STRATEGY

NARRATIIVE

Measurement Framework

LEADING / 3-6 MONTHS	Claim recognition, shelf comprehension, earned search share
LAGGING	Retail sell-through, blended CAC trend, subscriber retention
COMMERCIAL	Price realisation versus discount dependency

COMMERCIAL CONSEQUENCE

Net value and payback remain unavailable until KatKin supplies actual margin, retention and implementation cost.

SOURCES: T1

PROPOSED MEASUREMENT + EVIDENCE GAP

NARRATIIVE

Strategic Principle / Closing Mandate

Own the proof.

Make it easy to feel.

Then earn the right to scale.

IMMEDIATE NEXT STEP

Founder pressure-test and retail translation test

SOURCE REGISTER / governed companion deliverable included